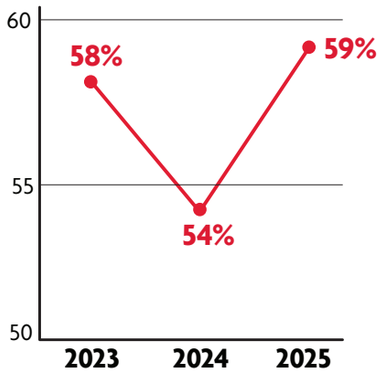
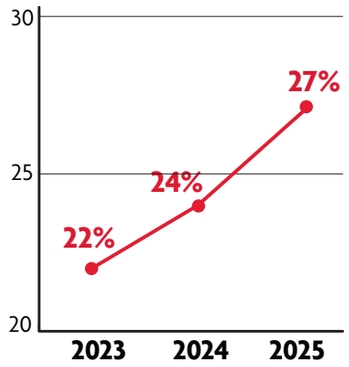
While price leads apparel purchase decisions, product materials are steadily gaining influence.

Factors that play the biggest role in apparel purchases:

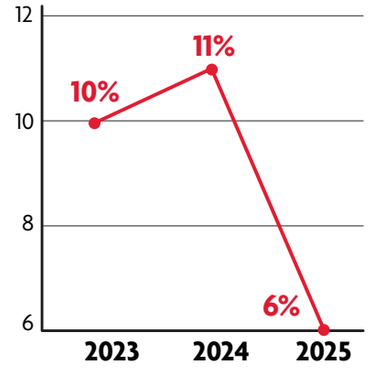
Price:



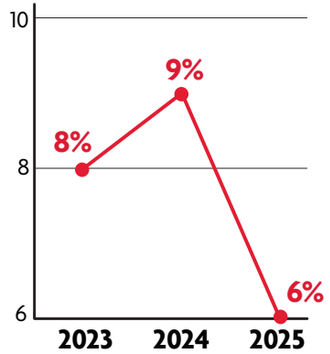
Materials used in the products:



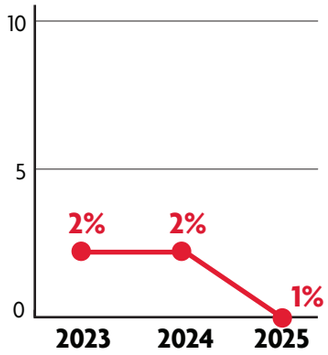
Company's ethical standards and policies:



Company's and product's environmental impact:



Purchases support a worthy cause:



Note: Percentages may not total 100% due to rounding and/or because respondents could select more than one answer.

METHODOLOGY
Annual E-commerce Consumer Study

In March 2025, Ryder hired a third-party research company to survey 1,376 online shoppers* about behavior, preferences, experiences, and expectations pertaining to their e-commerce activity from 2024 to 2025. Subject matter comprised purchasing behavior, packaging, shipping, returns, omnichannel experience, sustainability, and supply chain factors.

**All respondents reported shopping online either "often," "sometimes," or "all the time."*

Gender breakdown:	Male: **48%**	Other: **1%**
	Female: **51%**	
Age breakdown:	18-29: **10%**	46-60: **29%**
	30-44: **34%**	>60: **27%**
Regional breakdown:	South: **35%**	Midwest: **22%**
	West: **23%**	Northeast: **21%**

Note: Percentages may not total 100% due to rounding.



SPECIAL REPORT:

2025 HOLIDAY PREP



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SPECIAL REPORT:
INTRODUCTION

Each year, the peak holiday season comprises a unique set of circumstances. To explore consumers' needs, preferences, and behaviors during this time, in January 2025, Ryder contracted a third-party research company to survey 503 U.S. shoppers to gain actionable insights about the 2024 holiday shopping experience.

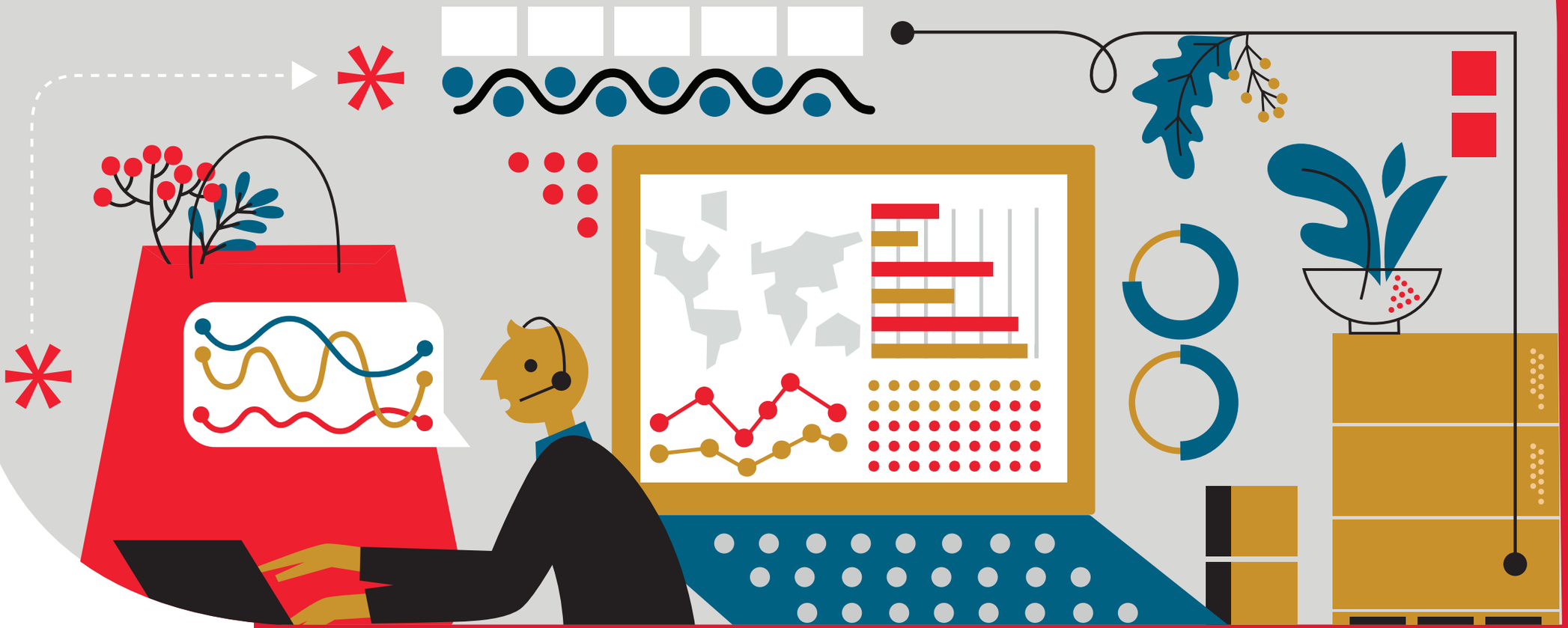
Observing the economic uncertainty that began to emerge just after that initial survey was conducted, Ryder followed up with a pulse survey of 525 U.S. shoppers in May 2025 to gather real-time insights on how these developments may have impacted consumer outlook for the 2025 holiday season.

This cumulative data from both surveys offers comprehensive insights that brands and retailers can apply to peak planning strategies.



HOLIDAY PREP REPORT:

E-COMMERCE TRENDS



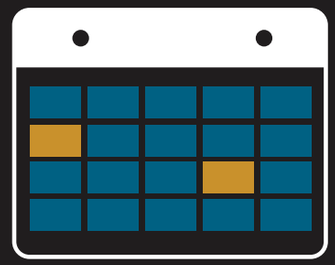
E-COMMERCE TRENDS: KEY TAKEAWAYS

- More than half of consumers plan to start 2025 holiday shopping before November.
- Sales and deals have the most impact on when shoppers will make 2025 holiday purchases.
- Comparison shopping was a favored 2024 holiday shopping tactic.
- Experiential gifts gained popularity in 2024.
- Social media was the leading driver of brand discovery in 2024 and may prove to be a popular shopping channel in 2025.
- More consumers plan to utilize Buy Now Pay Later (BNPL) services during the 2025 holiday shopping season.

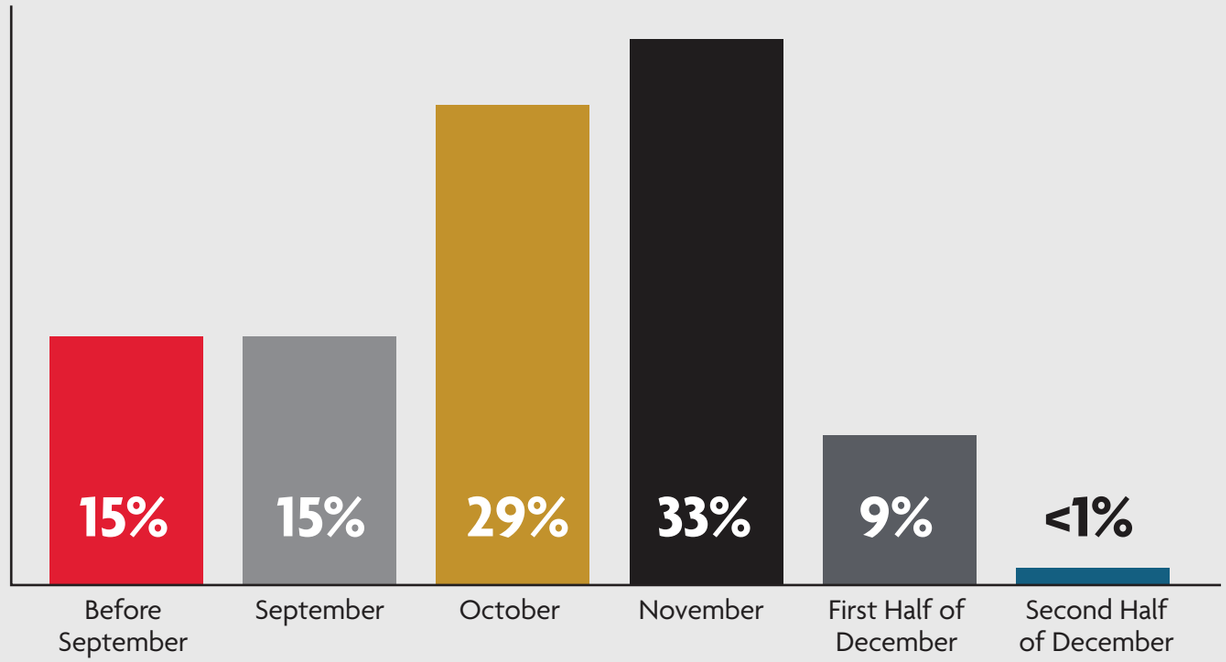


More than half of consumers plan to start 2025 holiday shopping before November.

59%
of consumers plan to start 2025 holiday shopping by the end of October.



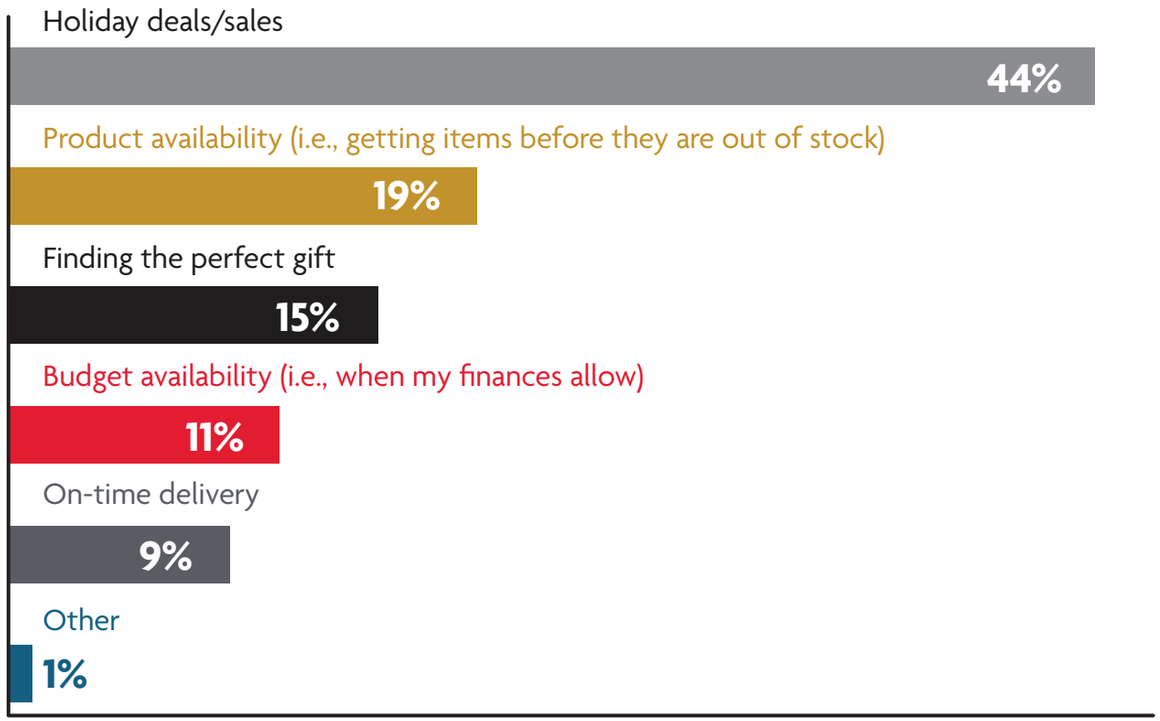
"When do you expect to begin your 2025 holiday shopping?"



Note: Percentages may not total 100% due to rounding and/or because respondents could select more than one answer.

Sales and deals have the most impact on when shoppers will make 2025 holiday purchases.

"Which of the following factors has the biggest influence over the timing of your holiday shopping?"



Note: Percentages may not total 100% due to rounding and/or because respondents could select more than one answer.

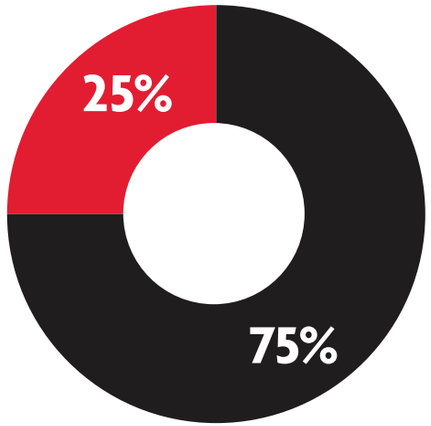
Of the shoppers who selected "product availability" or "on-time delivery,"

64%

expect to begin their holiday shopping before November.

Comparison shopping was a favored 2024 holiday shopping tactic.

Three-quarters of shoppers engaged in "comparison shopping" (i.e., comparing the price of a product from different vendors before buying) during the 2024 holiday season.



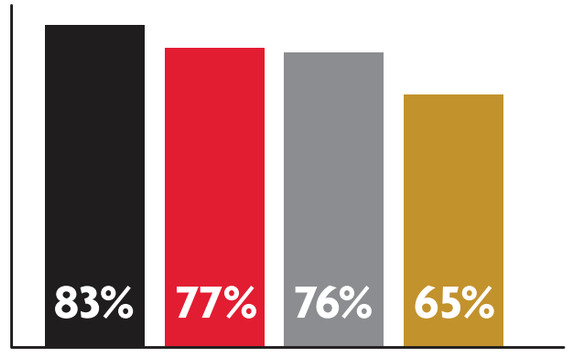
Comparison shopped

Did not comparison shop

Younger shoppers did more comparison shopping during the 2024 holiday season.

AGE GROUPS:

18-29 30-44 45-60 >60



Regardless of when consumers started their holiday shopping, comparison shopping played a role.



Shoppers who started their holiday shopping **earlier** than usual AND engaged in comparison shopping in 2024

Shoppers who started their holiday shopping **later** than usual AND engaged in comparison shopping in 2024

Note: Percentages may not total 100% due to rounding and/or because respondents could select more than one answer.

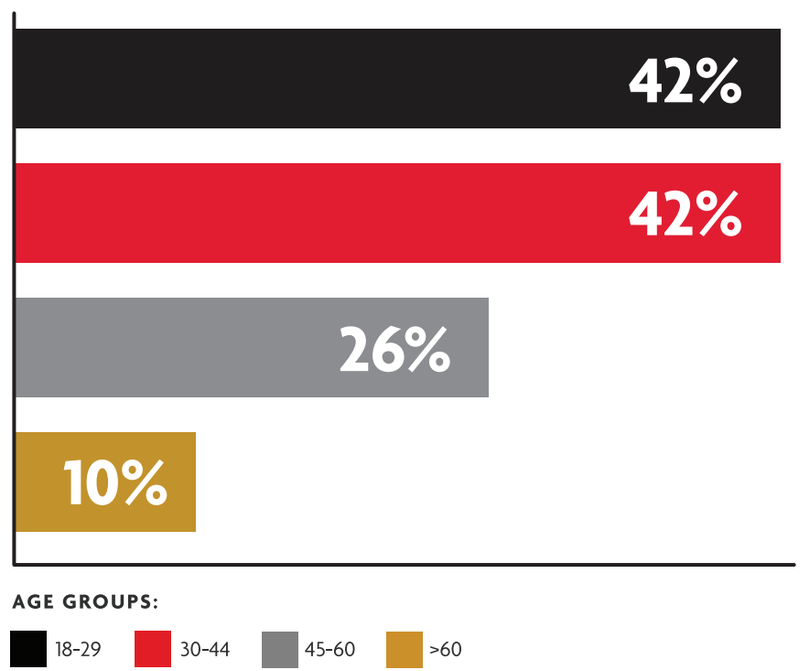
Experiential gifts gained popularity in 2024.

18% spent more money on experience-based holiday gifts in 2024 than in 2023.

52% spent more money on physical items than experience-based gifts during the 2024 holiday season.

30% spent more money on experience-based gifts than physical items during the 2024 holiday season.

Younger consumers were more likely to spend more on experiences than physical items.



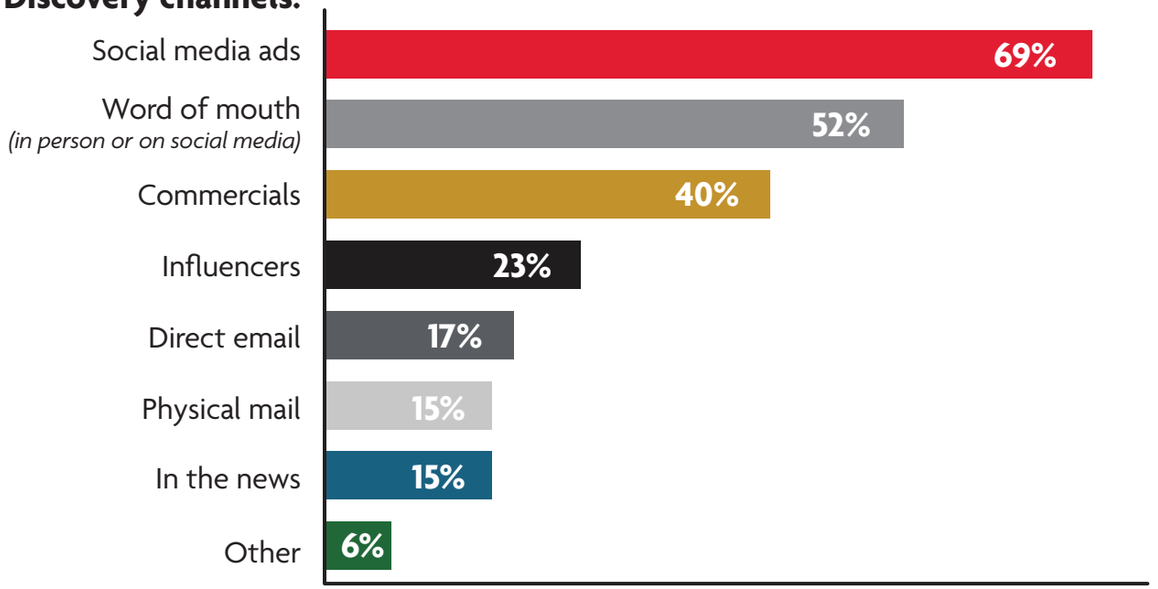
Note: Percentages may not total 100% due to rounding and/or because respondents could select more than one answer.

Social media was the leading driver of brand discovery in 2024 and may prove to be a popular shopping channel in 2025.

2024

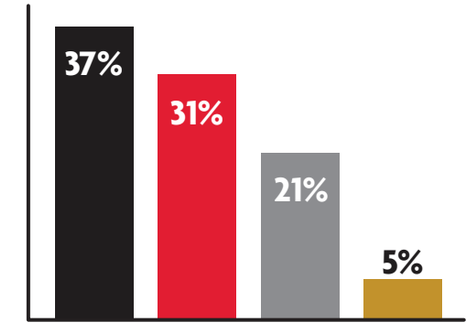
While holiday shopping in 2024, 10% of shoppers discovered new companies they plan to purchase from again. Of that group:

Discovery channels:



2025

Younger consumers, in particular, plan to shop using social media marketplaces during the 2025 holiday season:



Note: Percentages may not total 100% due to rounding and/or because respondents could select more than one answer.

More consumers plan to utilize Buy Now Pay Later (BNPL) services during the 2025 holiday shopping season.

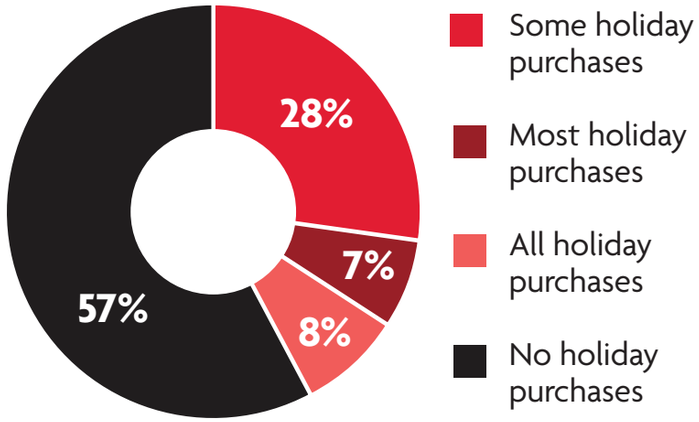
In March 2025:

24%
of consumers reported using BNPL services to purchase items online throughout the year.*

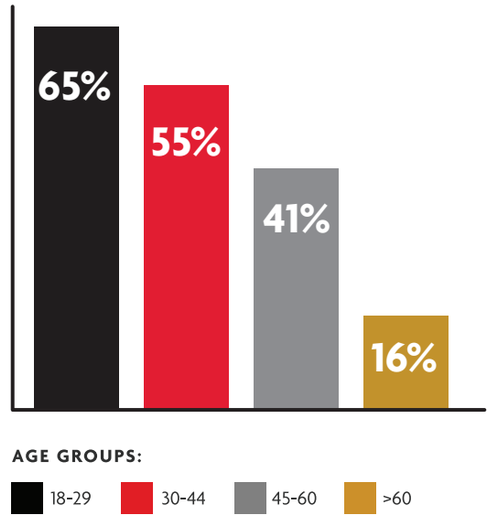
17%
reported using BNPL services more during the holiday shopping season than the rest of the year.*

In May 2025:

43%
of shoppers said they plan to use BNPL services during the 2025 holiday season.



The younger the respondent, the more likely they are to use BNPL for 2025 holiday purchases.



Data from 2025 E-commerce Consumer Study (March 2025)

Note: Percentages may not total 100% due to rounding and/or because respondents could select more than one answer.

HOLIDAY PREP REPORT:

PURCHASE BEHAVIOR



PURCHASE BEHAVIOR:
KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Cost-saving factors are the primary motivators of 2025 holiday purchasing decisions.
- Shoppers plan to spend less on less in 2025.
- Younger shoppers are showing the greatest effort to rein in spending in 2025.
- Apparel, electronics, and accessories led holiday shopping purchases.
- Shoppers rely on loyalty benefits to supplement holiday shopping.
- The younger the shopper, the more influenced they were by sustainable business practices.



Cost-saving factors are the primary motivators of 2025 holiday purchasing decisions.



"Which of the following factors are most likely to influence your 2025 holiday purchasing decisions? (Select up to 3 options)."

- **#1** Free shipping **76%**
- **#2** Sales/Discounts **64%**
- **#3** Free returns **31%**
- **#4** Fast shipping (2 days or less) **27%**
- **#5** Price matching **20%**
- **#6** Loyalty rewards **18%**
- **#7** Extended return window **11%**
- **#8** Scheduled delivery **9%**
- **#9** Products are made in the U.S.A. **9%**
- **#10** Buy Now Pay Later options **6%**
- **#11** Eco-friendly or sustainable product options **4%**

Note: Percentages may not total 100% due to rounding and/or because respondents could select more than one answer.

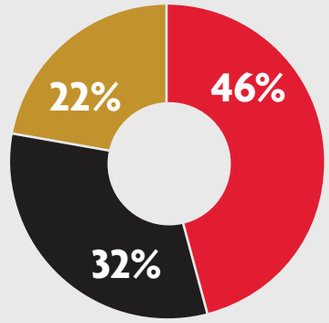
94% of respondents selected at least one of the top 3 factors.

Shoppers say they plan to spend less on less in 2025.

2024

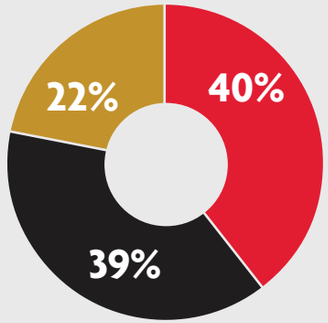
While almost half of shoppers reported spending more *money* on 2024 holiday shopping, a smaller percentage reported making more *purchases*.

Holiday Spending



- Spent more money in 2024 than in 2023.
- Spent less money in 2024 than in 2023.
- Spent about the same in 2024 as in 2023.

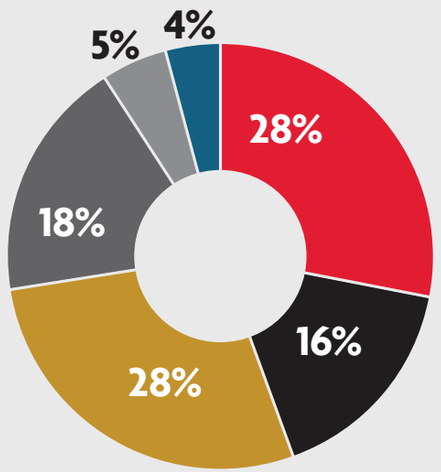
Holiday Purchases



- Made more purchases in 2024 than in 2023.
- Made fewer purchases in 2024 than in 2023.
- Made about the same in 2024 as in 2023.

2025

44% report planning to make fewer purchases during the 2025 holiday season in an attempt to spend less.



- *"I plan to make slightly fewer purchases in an attempt to spend less."*
- *"I plan to make significantly fewer purchases in an attempt to spend less."*
- *"I don't plan to make any changes in spending, even if that means I end up purchasing fewer items."*
- *"I plan to make the same number of purchases, even if I have to spend more due to product and/or shipping costs being higher."*
- *"I plan to make slightly more purchases, even if that means I end up spending more due to product and/or shipping costs being higher."*
- *"I plan to make significantly more purchases, even if that means I end up spending more due to product and/or shipping costs being higher."*

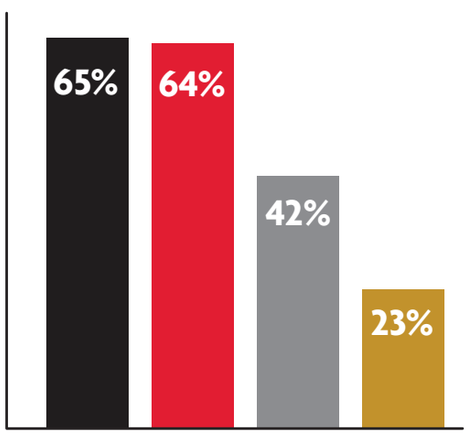
Note: Percentages may not total 100% due to rounding and/or because respondents could select more than one answer.

Younger shoppers are showing the greatest effort to rein in spending in 2025.

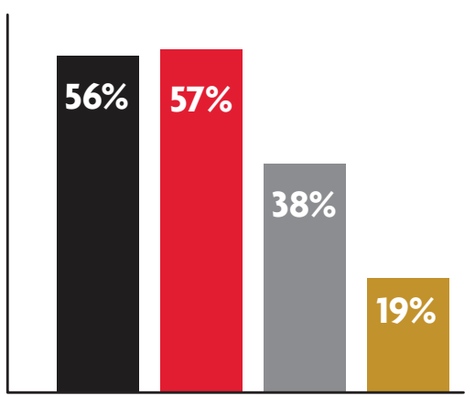
2024

Younger age groups reported both spending more *and* making more purchases during the 2024 holiday season.

Shoppers who spent more money in 2024 than they did in 2023:



Shoppers who made more purchases in 2024 than they did in 2023:

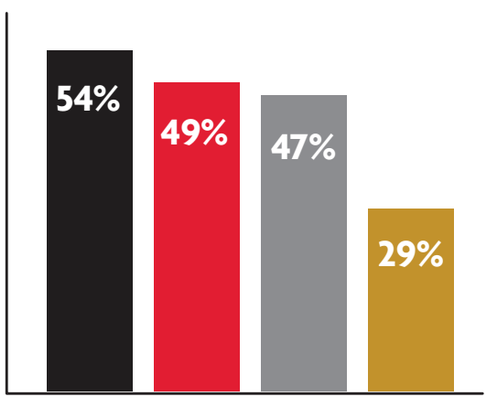


AGE GROUPS:

18-29 30-44 45-60 >60

2025

Shoppers who plan to make fewer purchases in 2025 in an attempt to spend less:



Note: Percentages may not total 100% due to rounding and/or because respondents could select more than one answer.

Apparel, electronics, and accessories led holiday shopping purchases.

"Which of the following items did you spend the most money on during the 2024 holiday season?"

TOP 3

Apparel: 70%

Electronics: 37%

Accessories: 28%

BOTTOM 3

Sporting Goods: 8%

Tools/Home Improvement Items: 8%

Cleaning Products: 9%

23% of shoppers gave gift cards more than usual in 2024.

Note: Percentages may not total 100% due to rounding and/or because respondents could select more than one answer.

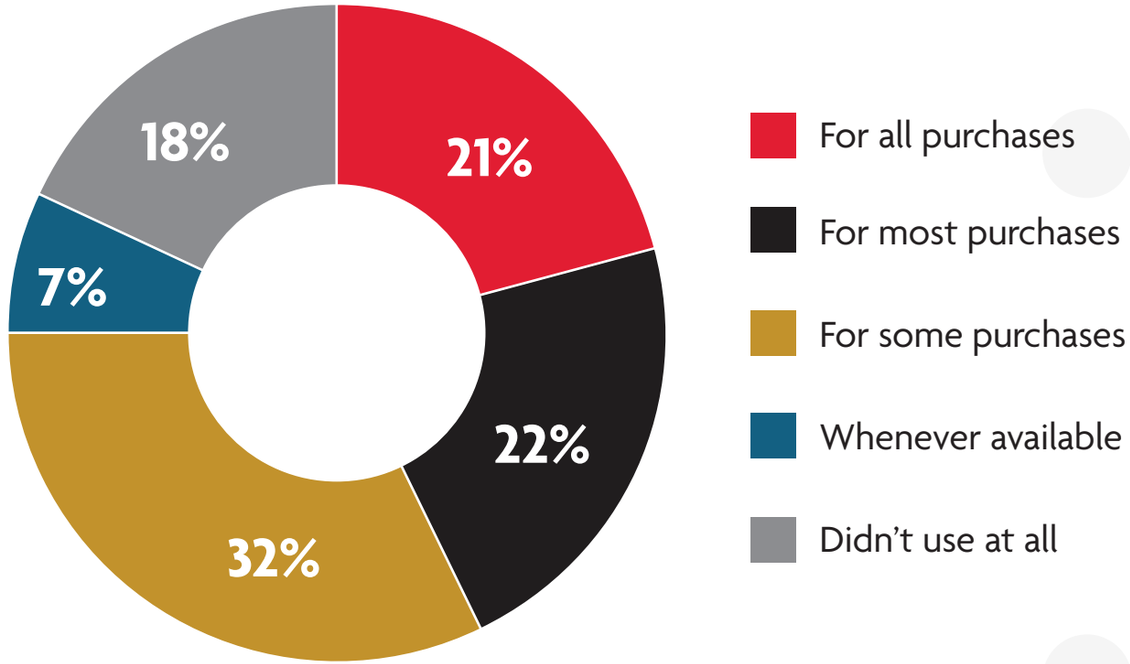
Shoppers rely on loyalty benefits to supplement holiday shopping.



82%

of shoppers reported using loyalty discounts or rewards to make 2024 holiday purchases.

How shoppers used loyalty discounts or rewards for 2024 holiday purchases:



Note: Percentages may not total 100% due to rounding and/or because respondents could select more than one answer.